

INTERNAL — CONFIDENTIAL

Backbone HR — B2B Sales Reference Guide

Product: Backbone HR

Company: Raven Tech Group

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Audience: B2B sales, business development, and client-facing account managers

How to Use This Document

This guide is your single reference for selling Backbone HR. Use it to:

- Understand what you are selling and who it is for
- Walk prospects through modules and value in discovery calls
- Position against competitors without overpromising
- Know what is live today vs. on the roadmap
- Run demos and handle common objections

Golden rule: We win on **fit, transparency, and accountability** — not on claiming the biggest feature list.

1. Product at a Glance

What is Backbone HR?

Backbone HR is an all-in-one Human Resource Information System (HRIS) built for **Kenyan and East African businesses**. It covers the full employee lifecycle:

***Hire → Onboard → Time → Pay → Perform → Exit** (and **Bill**, for HR outsourcers)*

Unlike multi-tenant SaaS platforms, each client gets a **dedicated deployment**: their own database, domain, branding, and environment. Data is isolated. The client owns their data.

One-Line Pitch

Backbone HR gives mid-market East African employers a right-sized HR and payroll operating system — transparent in cost, built for local statutory compliance, and directly accountable to the people building it.

What We Are Not

We are	We are not
Dedicated instance per client	Shared multi-tenant SaaS
Kenya/Uganda operational depth	Pan-African statutory on day one
Modular — buy what you need	All-or-nothing enterprise suite
Practitioner-built workflows	Generic global HRIS adapted for Africa
Direct founder/vendor access	Ticket-queue support model

2. Ideal Customer Profile (ICP)

Primary Segments

Segment	Why Backbone HR fits	Typical headcount
Mid-market employers (Kenya & East Africa)	Kenya-first payroll, statutory returns, ESS for field staff	50–2,000
Multi-entity operators	Kenya + Uganda entities, KES/UGX, consolidated reporting	100–1,000+
Operations-heavy businesses	Rota, attendance, biometrics, shift → payroll	100–5,000
Growing companies	ATS/careers, hire-to-onboard pipeline	30–500
HR outsourcers / payroll bureaus	Client billing, invoices, pass-through payroll markup	Varies
Manufacturing, O&G, fuel retail, logistics	HSE, credentials/compliance, station/depot structures	200–2,000

Buyer Personas

Persona	Title examples	What they care about
Finance executive	CFO, Finance Director, Group Finance Manager	Payroll control, statutory risk, predictable cost, audit trail
HR leader	HR Director, Head of HR, HRBP	Employee records, leave, onboarding, compliance, less admin
Operations leader	COO, Regional Manager, Depot Manager	Attendance, rota, station-level visibility
IT / Systems	IT Manager, Systems Analyst	Security, integrations, data ownership, uptime
Founder / MD	Managing Director, CEO	ROI, adoption, vendor accountability, growth readiness

Qualification Signals (Good Fit)

- Payroll or HR data scattered across spreadsheets, email, and WhatsApp
- Multi-location or multi-country workforce (Kenya/Uganda especially)
- Field or shift-based staff who need mobile self-service
- Finance wants cost visibility by department, branch, station, or cost centre
- Frustrated with opaque enterprise pricing or slow vendor support
- HR outsourcer billing multiple end-clients from one workforce

Disqualification Signals (Proceed Carefully)

- Needs pan-African statutory engines for 5+ countries on day one
- Requires SAP/Oracle-level ERP integration before go-live (possible later, not v1)
- Wants only a lightweight leave tracker with no payroll
- Expects native iOS/Android apps immediately (we are PWA-first)
- Needs performance management as a core requirement today (roadmap item)

3. Value Proposition by Stakeholder

For Finance

- **Predictable total cost** — transparent monthly fee, modular scope, no surprise module charges
- **Payroll control layer** — approvals, audit trail, statutory logic built in
- **Cost visibility** — headcount and payroll by entity, department, branch, cost centre
- **Compliance confidence** — Kenya PAYE, NSSF, SHIF, Affordable Housing Levy; Uganda support
- **Lower manual effort** — fewer spreadsheet reconciliations and correction cycles

For HR

- **Single system of record** — employee master data, documents, lifecycle events
- **Less repetitive work** — ESS handles payslip and leave requests
- **Structured workflows** — onboarding, offboarding, disciplinary, grievance

- **Recruitment pipeline** — jobs, applications, interviews, hire conversion
- **Credential tracking** — licence and certification expiry alerts

For Employees & Managers

- **Mobile-first ESS (PWA)** — payslips, leave, attendance, documents on phone
- **Simple approvals** — managers approve leave from their device
- **Transparency** — employees see balances, payslips, and policies without calling HR

For the Business (Executive)

- **Adoption-friendly** — designed for field and station staff, not only HQ
- **Direct accountability** — access to the builder, not a support queue
- **Flexible growth path** — start with payroll control, extend to attendance, ATS, HSE, analytics
- **Dedicated deployment** — data isolation, white-label branding, client owns their data

4. Module Catalog

Modules are licensed per deployment. Clients buy only what they need.

Core HR (*always included*)

Status: Live

Capability	Sales talking point
Employee master data & import	Trusted record for everything downstream
Departments & org structure	Reflects real operating units
Contracts & documents	Contracts, IDs, certificates linked to profiles
Onboarding / offboarding templates	Structured tasks, overdue reminders
Credentials & compliance tracking	Expiry alerts for licences, certifications
Multi-entity (Kenya + Uganda)	One system, separate legal entities

Leave Management

Status: Live

Capability	Sales talking point
Leave types, balances, policies	Financial liability tracked properly
Approval workflows	Traceable manager sign-off
Public holidays by country	Kenya/Uganda logic built in
ESS leave requests	Employees self-serve; HR stops chasing forms

Time & Attendance

Status: Live

Capability	Sales talking point
Rota & shift scheduling	Templates, periods, CSV import
Attendance policies & summaries	Exceptions flagged before payroll
Biometric integration (Hikvision)	Device punch import for ops-heavy sites
Shift engine → payroll	Closed loop from clock to pay

Roadmap: Geo mobile clock-in

Payroll (Kenya)

Status: Live

Capability	Sales talking point
Monthly & bi-weekly payroll runs	Matches how clients actually pay
Statutory: PAYE, NSSF, SHIF, AHL	Kenya compliance built into workflow
Payslip PDFs & email	Employees access via ESS
Statutory returns & exports (P9, P10, NSSF, SHIF)	Filing support, not just calculation
Bank payment file export	Disbursement-ready output
Multi-entity KES/UGX	Cross-border operators supported

Roadmap: Direct disbursement API (Flutterwave/Paystack); deeper Uganda statutory

Recruitment / ATS

Status: Live

Capability	Sales talking point
Public careers board	Branded job listings at /careers
Application pipeline & talent pool	Full hire funnel in one system
Multi-stage applications & CV upload	Professional candidate experience
Interview scheduling & Teams meetings	Integrated scheduling
Scorecards & offer approvals	Structured hiring decisions
Hire → employee conversion	No re-keying when someone joins

Employee Self-Service (ESS)

Status: Live

Capability	Sales talking point
Mobile-first PWA	Works on any smartphone; installable
Payslips, leave, attendance, documents	Reduces HR inbox volume
Manager approvals & team views	Managers act without logging into full HRIS
Google / Microsoft OAuth	Familiar login for corporate users
Offline-aware design	Field-friendly experience

Reports & Analytics

Status: Live

Capability	Sales talking point
Headcount & payroll cost reports	Finance dashboard, not manual Excel
Attendance & statutory CSV exports	Audit-ready outputs
Executive analytics view	Director-level people-cost visibility

Accounts / Finance *(for HR outsourcers)*

Status: Live

Capability	Sales talking point
Billing clients & engagement contracts	BPO/PEO revenue model supported
Sales invoices, credit notes, PDFs	Professional client billing
Receipts & allocations	AR tracking
Vendors, bills, payments	AP for the outsourcer's own ops
Payroll visibility for billing context	Markup on pass-through payroll

Disciplinary & Grievance

Status: Live

Capability	Sales talking point
Case workflows (staff + ESS)	Structured, documented process
EAC jurisdiction support	Regional legal context

Asset Manager

Status: Live

Capability	Sales talking point
Asset registry & assignments	Track company equipment by employee

Performance Management

Status: Roadmap (UI prototype only)

- Dashboard mock exists; real goals, review cycles, and OKRs are planned (Phase 5)
- **Do not sell as live.** Say: "Foundation is in place; full performance module on roadmap."

HSE (Health, Safety & Environment)

Status: Partial / Roadmap

- Incident reporting UI exists; full persistence and workflows are planned (Phase 6)
- **Sell the vision** for O&G, manufacturing, fuel retail — position as Phase 2 extension
- Strong talking point: certification tracking and site-level compliance (credentials module is live)

5. Commercial Packages

Clients are licensed by module. Suggested bundles:

Bundle	Modules	Best for
Essentials	Core HR + Leave + Payroll	Any employer needing HR + pay
Workforce	Essentials + Time & Attendance	Shift/ops-heavy businesses
Talent	Essentials + Recruitment (ATS)	Growing companies hiring actively
Outsourcer	Essentials + Time + ATS + Accounts	HR outsourcers / payroll bureaus
Full	All modules enabled	Large operators wanting everything

Pricing Guidance

Commercial model: Dedicated deployment with transparent monthly fee. No multi-tenant shared pricing tiers.

Element	Guidance
Pricing anchor	~KES 300/employee/month at ~500 employees
Reference monthly fee	KES 150,000/month for agreed core scope (HRIS, payroll, leave, ESS, reporting, hosting, support)
Setup fee	Negotiable; can be waived for strategic pilots
What's included	Hosting, core modules in scope, support, direct vendor access
Add-ons	Biometrics, ERP integration, bespoke analytics — scoped and priced separately

How to talk about price:

You are not buying software for KES 150,000. You are buying payroll control, compliance visibility, staff self-service, and management reporting for roughly KES 300 per employee per month. That is a small cost relative to payroll value, statutory exposure, and manual effort saved.

Important: Always confirm scope in writing. Price varies by headcount, modules, entities, and integration requirements.

6. Competitive Positioning

vs. Enterprise HRIS (e.g. SeamlessHR)

Do not attack competitors. Finance buyers respect maturity.

Decision area	Enterprise platform	Backbone HR
Market profile	Larger, established, broad suite	Specialist, directly accountable
Product approach	Many client types, many modules	Focused on East African operational reality
Pricing	Quote-based, module-dependent	Transparent, agreed monthly scope
Implementation	Standard vendor path	Direct founder-led rollout
Adaptability	Vendor roadmap & support queues	Faster configuration, direct escalation
Deployment	Often shared or complex	Dedicated instance per client
Risk profile	Lower brand risk, higher cost/fit uncertainty	Lower cost/adoption risk; mitigate with pilot + SLA

Positioning line:

SeamlessHR is a credible platform. The question is not whether they are good — it is whether your organisation needs a broad enterprise suite, or a right-sized solution configured around your Kenya/Uganda operations with transparent cost and direct accountability.

vs. Spreadsheets + Email + WhatsApp

Pain today	Backbone HR outcome
Payroll errors and rework	Automated statutory logic and approvals
No audit trail	Traceable changes and role-based access
HR buried in routine requests	ESS self-service
Management waits for reports	Live dashboards and exports
Compliance exposure	Built-in Kenya statutory engine
Ghost records and leakage	Single system of record

vs. Global HRIS (BambooHR, Workday, etc.)

- Global tools often lack **Kenya/Uganda statutory depth**
- Global pricing in USD can be expensive for mid-market EA employers
- Backbone HR is **practitioner-built for local operations**, not adapted from US/EU templates

7. Discovery Questions

Use these to uncover pain and qualify the opportunity.

Opening (any buyer)

1. How do you manage employee records and payroll today?
2. How many employees, and across how many locations or countries?
3. What breaks most often — payroll accuracy, leave tracking, approvals, or reporting?
4. Who is involved in a typical payroll run, and how long does it take?

Finance-specific

1. What does payroll look like across entities — separate runs, consolidated review, or both?
2. Where do payroll delays come from: HR inputs, approvals, attendance/overtime, statutory checks, or reporting?
3. How do you currently see staff cost by department, branch, station, or entity?
4. What report do you wish you could get instantly but currently wait for?
5. What would make this decision easy to defend internally?

HR-specific

1. How much time does your team spend on payslip requests and leave enquiries?
2. How do you track onboarding, contracts, and certification renewals today?
3. Do you recruit internally or use external tools for hiring?

Operations-specific

1. Do you have shift workers, station staff, or depot teams?

2. How is attendance captured today — manual, biometric, or not at all?
3. Does overtime or attendance feed into payroll automatically?

The best closing discovery question

What would you need to see in the first 90 days to feel confident this was the right decision?

8. Demo Guide (30 Minutes)

Demo tenant: Stabex International (petroleum retail, Kenya + Uganda) — use to show multi-entity, stations, depots, field staff.

Do not demo every module. Lead with finance, compliance, and operational control.

Recommended Flow

Step	Show	Say
1. Executive dashboard	Headcount by entity, payroll cost, pending approvals	"This is the view finance needs before payroll becomes a payment obligation."
2. Multi-entity payroll	Kenya/Uganda switch, currency, statutory deductions, approval, payslip	"Your operating reality — two countries, one system."
3. Cost-centre reporting	Payroll/headcount by department, station, depot	"The system explains where payroll cost sits."
4. Leave + ESS (brief)	Employee leave request, manager approval, payslip on phone	"Adoption matters — staff can use this without heavy training."
5. Future vision (brief)	HSE or credentials expiry	"For ops-heavy industries, we extend into safety and compliance tracking."

Demo Access

Portal	URL path	Notes
Staff dashboard	<code>/dashboard/login</code>	HR, payroll, finance, admin
Employee self-service	<code>/ess/login</code>	Mobile-first PWA
Careers board	<code>/careers</code>	Public ATS face

Demo credentials available when `DEMO_MODE=true` — ask your manager for current access.

9. Objection Handling

Objection	Response
"Why are you cheaper than enterprise vendors?"	We price for your actual footprint, not large-vendor overhead. The advantage is predictable total cost — not just lower price.
"Are you established enough?"	Fair concern. We reduce risk with a written SLA, controlled pilot, clear success criteria, data ownership terms, and a clean exit clause.
"What if payroll fails?"	Parallel validation before go-live. We compare outputs against your current payroll, confirm statutory calculations, and only go live after finance sign-off.
"What happens if something breaks?"	Critical payroll-period issues get priority handling with direct escalation. SLA defines response times in writing.
"Can this integrate with our other systems?"	Yes — APIs and structured exports. Start with payroll reports and journal exports; extend to biometrics, ERP, Power BI as needed.
"Why not choose the bigger vendor?"	Valid option. The question is fit. We offer Kenya/Uganda depth, transparent cost, faster adaptation, and lower adoption friction — with pilot-based risk control.
"Will this scale as we grow?"	Yes. Start with HR and payroll control; extend to attendance, HSE, ERP, and analytics on the same foundation.
"Is performance management included?"	Not yet live. Core HR, payroll, leave, time, ATS, and ESS are market-ready. Performance is on the roadmap — we will not oversell it.

10. Risk-Reversal & Closing

Proposed Pilot Structure

Element	Recommendation
Duration	3 months
Scope	One entity first (e.g. Kenya), controlled expansion
Users	HR, payroll, finance reviewer, selected managers, ESS sample group
Success metrics	Payroll accuracy, statutory match, payslip delivery, leave workflow, reporting, SLA adherence
Exit clause	Client can exit if agreed criteria are not met

SLA & Governance (Offer in Writing)

- Uptime target defined in service agreement
- Payroll-period priority support
- Response time tiers (critical / high / medium / low)
- Named escalation contact
- Monthly review in first 3 months

- Data backup and recovery documented
- Role-based access control
- **Data ownership stays with the client**
- Export support if client exits

Recommended Close

The pricing is clear enough for finance to defend. My recommendation is a controlled 3-month pilot — agree success metrics upfront, put the SLA and exit terms in writing, and let the system prove itself in your environment.

11. Implementation Overview

What the client gets:

1. **Dedicated instance** — own database (Neon PostgreSQL), hosting (Vercel), custom domain
2. **Branded deployment** — logo, colours, org name, white-label option
3. **Module configuration** — only licensed modules enabled
4. **Data migration** — employee and payroll data imported with parallel validation
5. **Go-live support** — founder-led, with finance sign-off before live payroll

Typical timeline:

Phase	Duration	Activities
Scoping	1–2 weeks	Modules, entities, integrations, success criteria
Provisioning	< 1 day	DB, hosting, branding, env configuration
Configuration	1–3 weeks	Payroll rules, leave policies, org structure, users
Migration & validation	2–4 weeks	Data import, parallel payroll runs, UAT
Go-live	1 payroll cycle	Finance sign-off, ESS rollout to employees

Provisioning target: Under 4 hours for a fresh dedicated instance.

12. Security & Compliance Summary

Area	What we offer
Deployment model	Dedicated DB per client — no shared multi-tenant data
Authentication	Separate staff and ESS sessions; Google/Microsoft OAuth
MFA	TOTP available; can be required for admins
Access control	Role-based permissions enforced on UI and APIs
Audit log	Admin activity trail for sensitive actions
Module gating	Disabled modules blocked at middleware and API level
Kenya statutory	PAYE, NSSF, SHIF, Affordable Housing Levy in payroll engine
Data ownership	Client owns their data; export supported on exit
Backups	Neon backup strategy per deployment
White-label	Optional "powered by" removal for client branding

13. Integrations

Live Today

Integration	Purpose
PostgreSQL (Neon)	Primary database
Vercel	Hosting, file storage, scheduled jobs
SMTP / Microsoft 365	Transactional email
Microsoft / Google OAuth	Staff and ESS login
Hikvision ISAPI	Biometric attendance import
Microsoft Teams	Interview meeting creation
Bank file export	Payroll disbursement files
CSV / Excel	Employee import, rota, reports
PDF generation	Payslips, invoices

Available on Scope (Not Default)

Integration	Notes
ERP (Sage, QuickBooks, Xero)	Payroll journal export; full connector scoped per client
Flutterwave / Pystack	Direct salary disbursement (roadmap)
Power BI / advanced analytics	Export + custom integration
Additional biometric devices	Beyond Hikvision — scoped per client

14. Honest Product Status

Sell with confidence (live):

- Core HR, Leave, Time & Attendance, Payroll (Kenya), ATS, ESS, Reports, Accounts, Disciplinary, Assets, Biometrics

Position as roadmap (do not oversell):

- Performance management (mock UI only)
- HSE full workflow (partial)
- Geo mobile clock-in
- Direct payroll disbursement API
- ERP connectors
- Pan-African statutory beyond Kenya/Uganda depth
- Native iOS/Android apps (PWA is the current answer)
- Public marketing / pricing website (in progress)

Why honesty wins: Mid-market buyers have been burned by vendors who oversell. Our credibility is a sales asset.

15. Quick Reference Card

PRODUCT:

Backbone HR

COMPANY:

Raven Tech Group

MODEL:

Dedicated deployment per client (not multi-tenant SaaS)

MARKET:

Kenya & East Africa – mid-market + HR outsourcers

PITCH:

Right-sized, transparent, locally compliant, directly accountable

BUNDLES:

Essentials | Workforce | Talent | Outsourcer | Full

PRICE ANCHOR:

~KES 300/employee/month | ~KES 150k/month at ~500 heads

WIN ON:

Fit · Transparency · Accountability · Adoption · Kenya/Uganda depth

DON'T WIN ON:

Biggest feature list

DEMO FLOW:

Dashboard → Payroll → Cost centres → ESS → Future vision

CLOSE WITH:

3-month pilot · written SLA · success metrics · exit clause

LIVE:

Core HR, Leave, Time, Payroll, ATS, ESS, Reports, Accounts

ROADMAP:

Performance, HSE (full), ERP, disbursement API, geo clock-in

16. Contacts & Resources

Resource	Location
Product master plan	hris-demo/docs/PRODUCT-MASTER-PLAN.md
Client provisioning runbook	hris-demo/docs/CLIENT-PROVISIONING.md
ESS platform spec	hris-demo/docs/ESS-PLATFORM-SPEC.md
Executive proposal example	Stabex_Executive_Proposal_Enriched.md
Demo seed data	Stabex International (Kenya + Uganda petroleum retail)

For pricing approvals, custom scope, or technical integration questions — escalate to Raven Tech Group leadership before committing in writing.

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